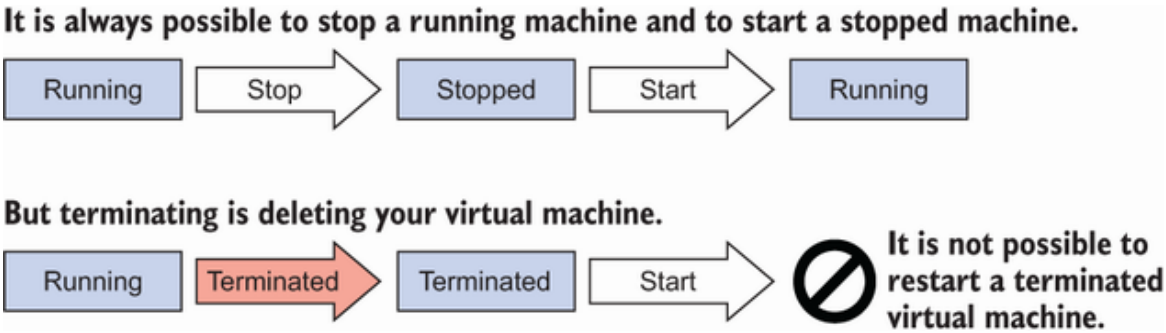



**Figure 3.19 The difference between stopping and terminating a virtual machine**

Stopping or terminating unused virtual machines saves costs and prevents you from being surprised by an unexpected bill from AWS. You may want to stop or terminate unused virtual machines when the following situations arise:

- You have launched virtual machines to implement a proof of concept. After finishing the project, the virtual machines are no longer needed. Therefore, you can terminate them.
- You are using a virtual machine to test a web application. Because no one else uses the virtual machine, you can stop it before you knock off work and start it back up again the following day.
- One of your customers canceled their contract. After backing up the relevant data, you can terminate the virtual machines that had been used for your former customer.

After you terminate a virtual machine, it’s no longer available and eventually disappears from the list of virtual machines.



## Cleaning up